
BUYER TIP 1
BEFORE YOU TOUR. GET PRE-APPROVED.
KNOW YOUR NUMBER BEFORE YOU FALL FOR A HOUSE
A preapproval letter says what a lender is tentatively willing to lend. Start there, and your weekends go to homes that fit.
BUYER TIPS
1 / 10 · SWIPE →



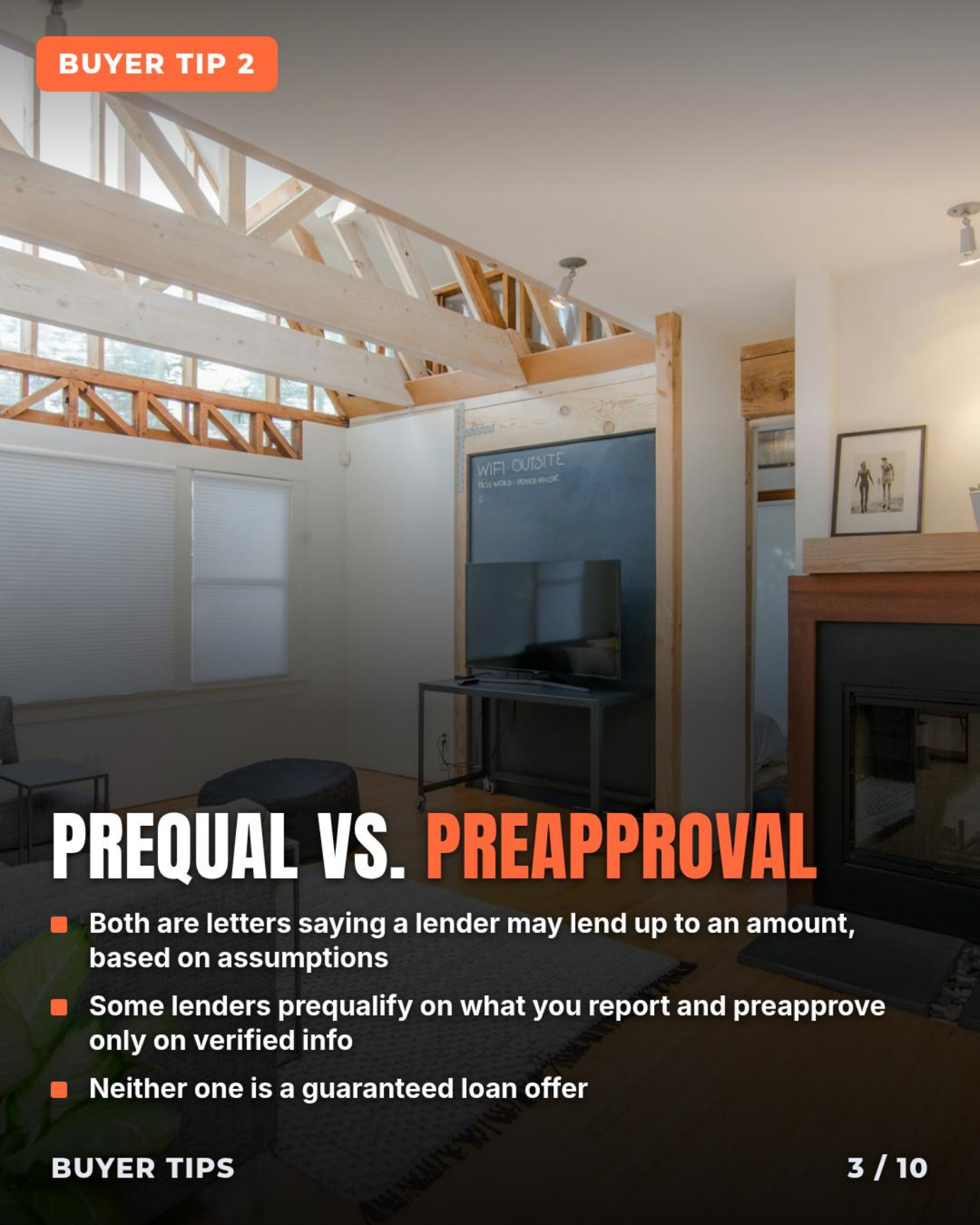
THE MARKET

SOUTHPARK · AS OF SEPTEMBER 2026

MEDIAN LIST	$625,000
MEDIAN SOLD	$610,000
ACTIVE	573 homes
DAYS ON MKT	53 (median)

Source: Realtor.com Economic Research, SouthPark page, Sep 2026

BUYER TIP 2



PREQUAL VS. PREAPPROVAL

- Both are letters saying a lender may lend up to an amount, based on assumptions
- Some lenders prequalify on what you report and preapprove only on verified info
- Neither one is a guaranteed loan offer

BUYER TIP 3



BUILD YOUR LENDER PACKET

- Pay stubs for the last 30 days
- W-2s and signed federal tax returns, last two years
- Your two most recent bank statements
- Proof of your down payment source + photo ID

BUYER TIP 4



WHAT A STRONG LETTER TELLS A SELLER

- Sellers frequently require one before accepting an offer
- It should state the lender reviewed your credit, income and cash to close
- Ask the lender what assumptions they made

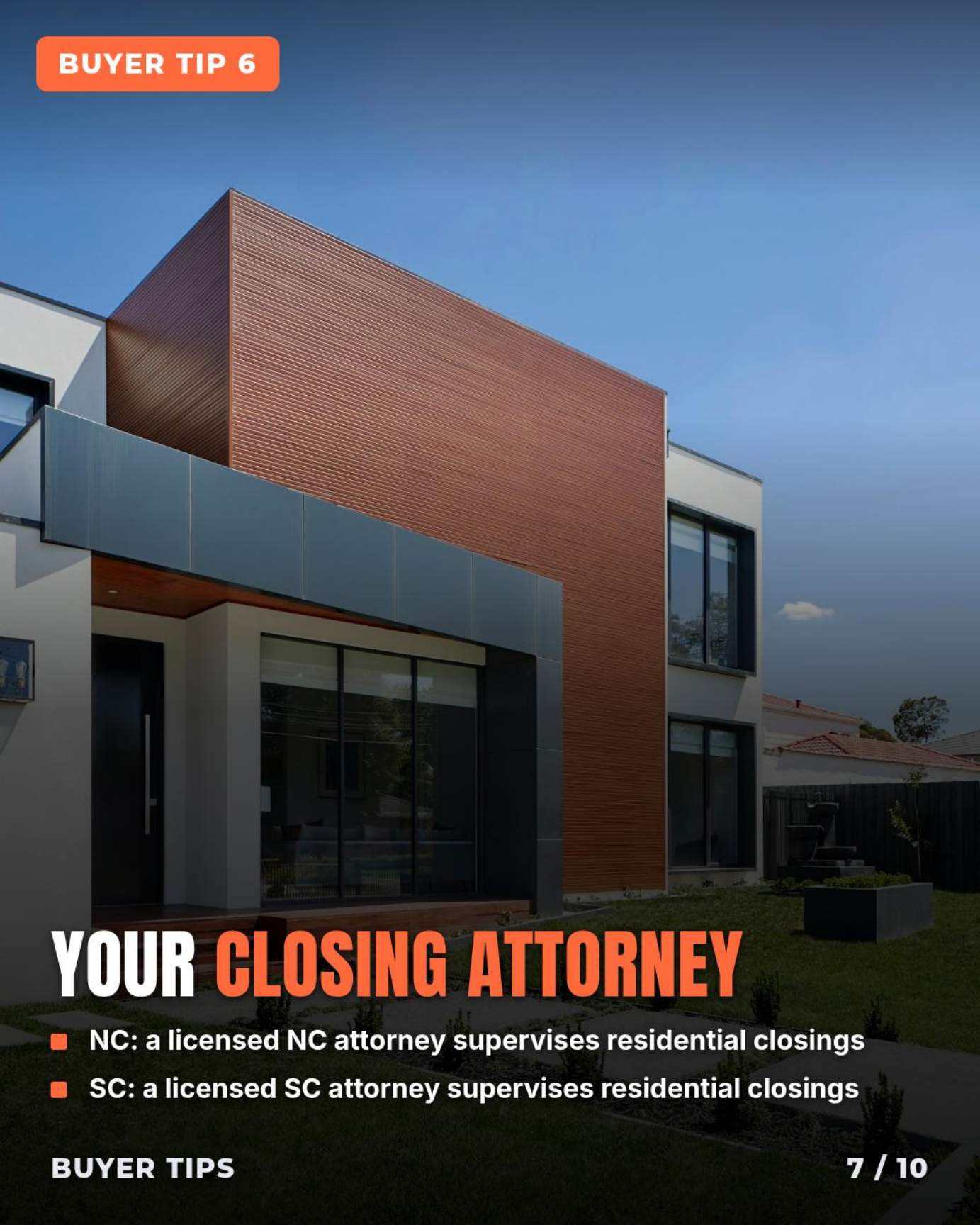
BUYER TIP 5



TWO NC DEPOSITS TO PLAN FOR

- Earnest money: common, held in trust by an escrow agent
- Due diligence fee: negotiated and paid directly to the seller
- It's generally non-refundable, but credited toward the price if you close

BUYER TIP 6



YOUR CLOSING ATTORNEY

- NC: a licensed NC attorney supervises residential closings
- SC: a licensed SC attorney supervises residential closings

BUYER TIP 7



TOUR WITH A WRITTEN PLAN

- Set your price ceiling from your own budget, not only the letter
- Tell your agent you don't want to see homes above it
- List must-haves and nice-to-haves before the first showing


AVOID THIS
DON'T FALL FIRST
Touring before you know your number
Letting the maximum approval set your budget
Letting your letter expire mid-search (typically 30 to 60 days)

MY RECOMMENDATION



LETTER FIRST, THEN THE TOUR

Talk with a lender, gather your packet, and then let's plan a SouthPark tour around your number.

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